Assessment 1 – Web Development Project Prototype

Caravaggio: Light, Shadow, Blood

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COMP-2002 Web Development

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CARAVAGGIO: LIGHT, SHADOW, BLOOD

Assessment 1: Web Development Project Prototype | COMP-2002 Web Development, Fall 2026 | Open Institute of Technology (OPIT) | Professor: Filip Biały | Author: Alessandro Benevelli



Opening screen of the interactive prototype: introductory video, title, the three chapter names and the language selector.

Interactive prototype

Open the interactive Figma prototype (desktop browser recommended). Source repository with design notes, credits and the full multilingual text archive: github.com/alessandrob1-star/caravaggio-light-shadow-blood.

Project purpose

The project is an immersive digital exhibition about Caravaggio. Paintings come first, then selected details, then a short anecdote. A longer explanation appears only when the visitor asks for it. The story is told through three chapters: **LIGHT** (light, matter and the presence of the sacred), **SHADOW** (human imperfection, scandal and personal struggle) and **BLOOD** (violence, mortality and the search for protection).

What the prototype demonstrates

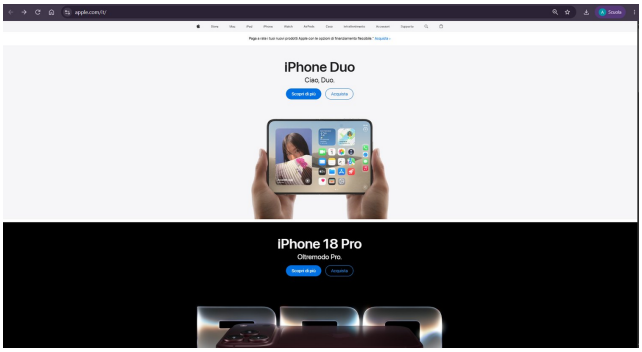
- One continuous **vertical journey** through the opening screen and three chapters, with an independent **horizontal gallery** inside each chapter.
- **20 detail helpers**: a gold button opens a focused overlay with the selected crop and a longer explanation, closed by the × or by clicking outside the panel.
- **Eight stored languages** (Italian, English, German, French, Simplified Chinese, Japanese, Polish, Dutch) applied to both anecdotes and helpers: 320 text entries, no translation API.
- Hover feedback on the helper buttons, reusable components, text styles and variables.
- A clear separation between what the prototype does and what is planned for the website (page 6).

Design intent and references

Two websites directly inspired the composition. Both ideas were adapted to the subject rather than copied.

Apple: contrast and empty space

What I liked on Apple's website is the contrast between light and dark sections and the way centred images are surrounded by generous empty space. I applied it as distinct backgrounds for the chapters (cream for LIGHT, charcoal for SHADOW, warm beige with red typography and a thin red line for BLOOD) and as restrained backgrounds that keep the eye on the painting. The choice also connects to Caravaggio, whose paintings reduce the background to concentrate attention on the figures. This link was one of the reasons for choosing him.



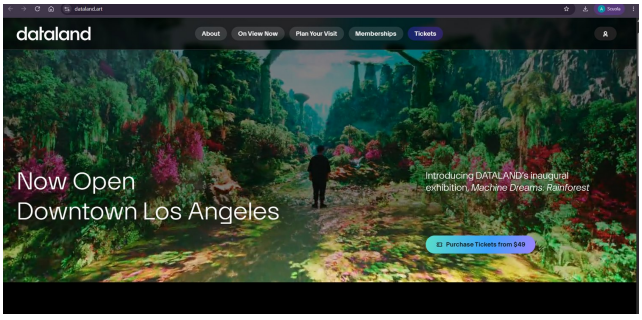
Reference: Apple website (screenshot supplied by the author; content belongs to its owner).



Prototype, LIGHT chapter: the painting is centred with generous space around it.

DATALAND: opening video and visible neighbours

From dataland.art, the website of the Museum of AI Arts in Los Angeles, I took two ideas. The first is a near-full-screen opening video that establishes the atmosphere before anything else. The second is a central item with parts of its neighbours visible at the sides, which tells visitors that more content continues and invites them to scroll sideways.



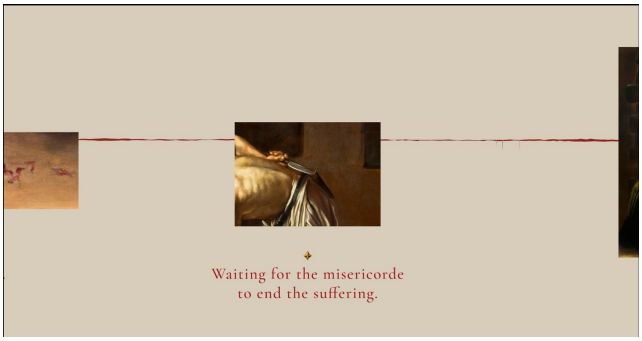
Reference: DATALAND opening video (screenshot supplied by the author).



Prototype: large introductory montage beneath the title.



Reference: central text with neighbouring text partly visible.

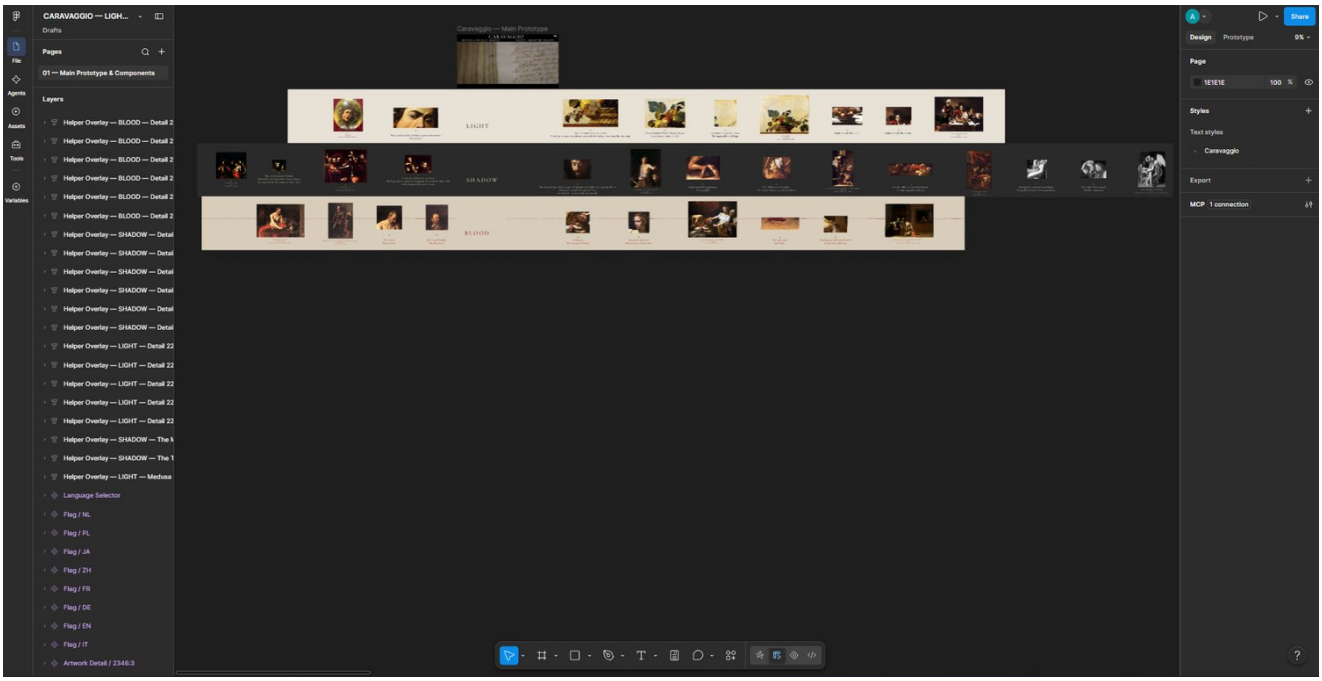


Prototype, BLOOD gallery: a central detail with fragments of neighbouring artworks at both edges.

Structure and navigation

One vertical journey, three horizontal galleries.

The main desktop frame is 1920 x 1018 and scrolls vertically. It connects the opening screen with the LIGHT, SHADOW and BLOOD chapters. Each chapter has its own 1920 x 1018 horizontal scrolling frame containing one long content frame with the chapter title, complete paintings, selected crops, captions and helper buttons. The chapters are continuous compositions, not sequences of separate slides.



Figma canvas: the opening frame above the three extended chapter tracks, and the layers panel with the 20 helper overlays, the language selector and the flag components.

Level	Figma structure	Responsibility
Main prototype	Vertical scrolling frame	Moves from the opening screen through the chapters
Chapter viewport	Horizontal scrolling frame	Explores a chapter without leaving its vertical position
Extended content	One long frame per chapter	Holds artworks, details, captions and the title continuously
Helper overlay	Separate focused frame	Shows a selected detail and its explanation above the gallery

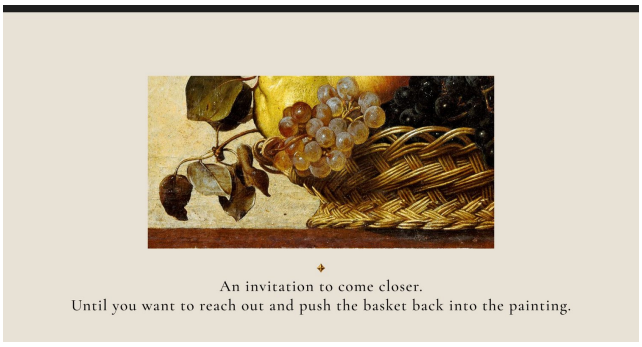
The horizontal tracks are 13,589 px (LIGHT), 18,489 px (SHADOW) and 14,457 px (BLOOD) long. Complete paintings carry title, year and collection or location. Selected details carry a short anecdote and a gold helper button.

Reusable elements

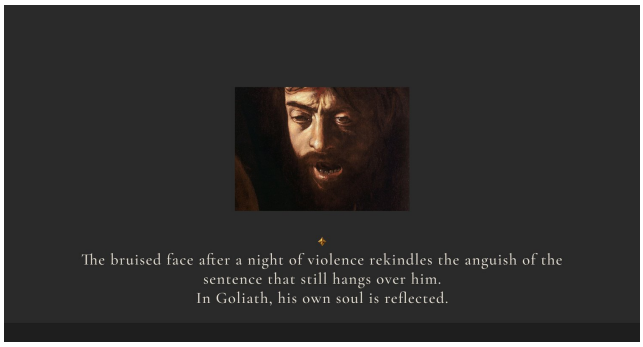
The file contains components for artwork and detail text blocks, the help controls, the language selector and the flags, together with shared text styles and variable collections. Most detail blocks are component instances; two later additions to SHADOW use separately configured frames.

The three chapters

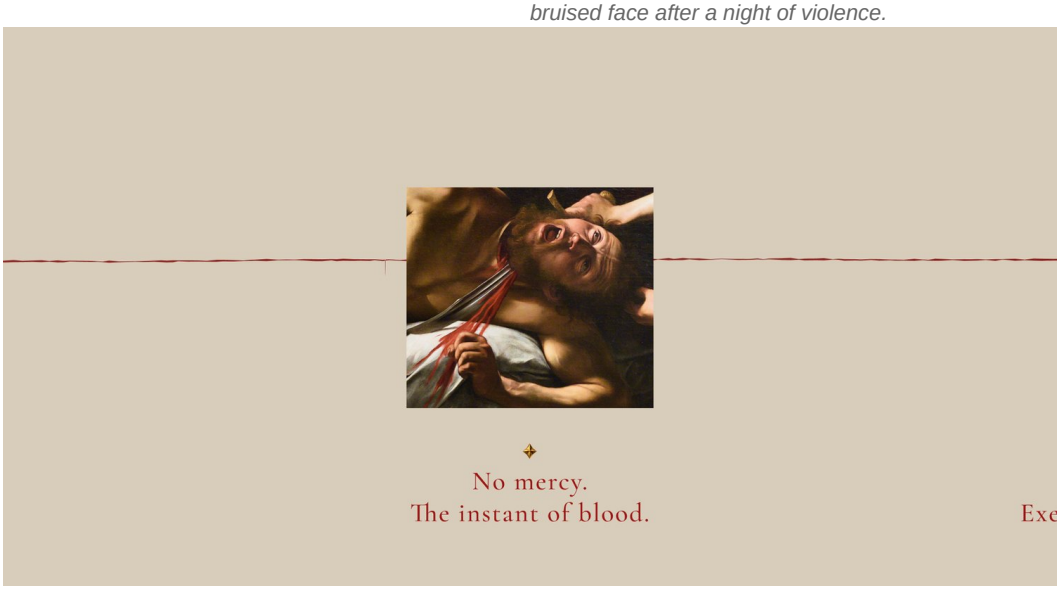
Each chapter has its own background and tone, so the colour change itself marks a change in the story.



LIGHT *(cream). Basket of Fruit, detail: "An invitation to come closer."*



SHADOW *(charcoal). David with the Head of Goliath, detail: the bruised face after a night of violence.*



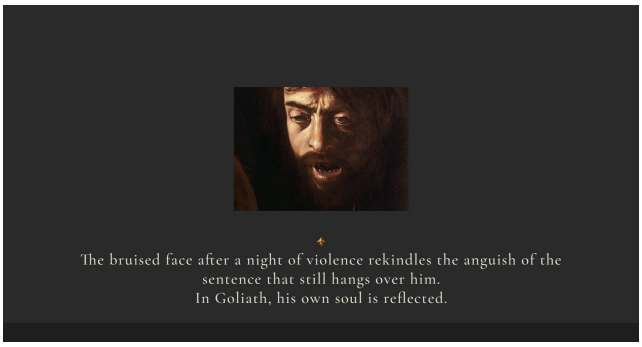
BLOOD *(warm beige, red typography, red line). Judith Beheading Holofernes, detail: "No mercy. The instant of blood." Parts of the neighbouring caption are visible at the right edge as a cue to keep scrolling.*

Two levels of storytelling

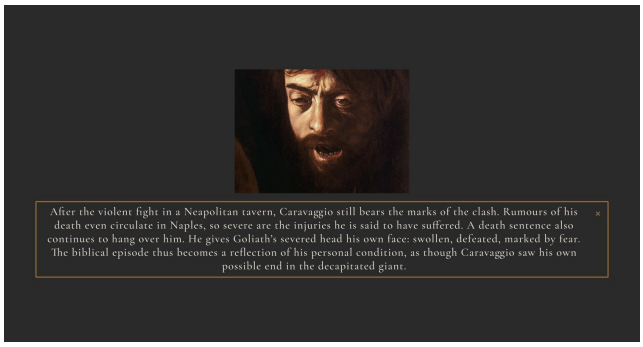
Short anecdotes stay visible in the gallery and leave room for interpretation. Longer explanations appear only on request, through the gold button. This keeps the visual experience uninterrupted and still offers depth to visitors who want it.

Interaction: helpers and languages

From a visible anecdote to an optional, focused explanation.



1. In the gallery: detail with its short anecdote and the gold helper button.



2. After clicking the button: the helper overlay with the crop and one gold-bordered explanation panel.

How the helpers behave

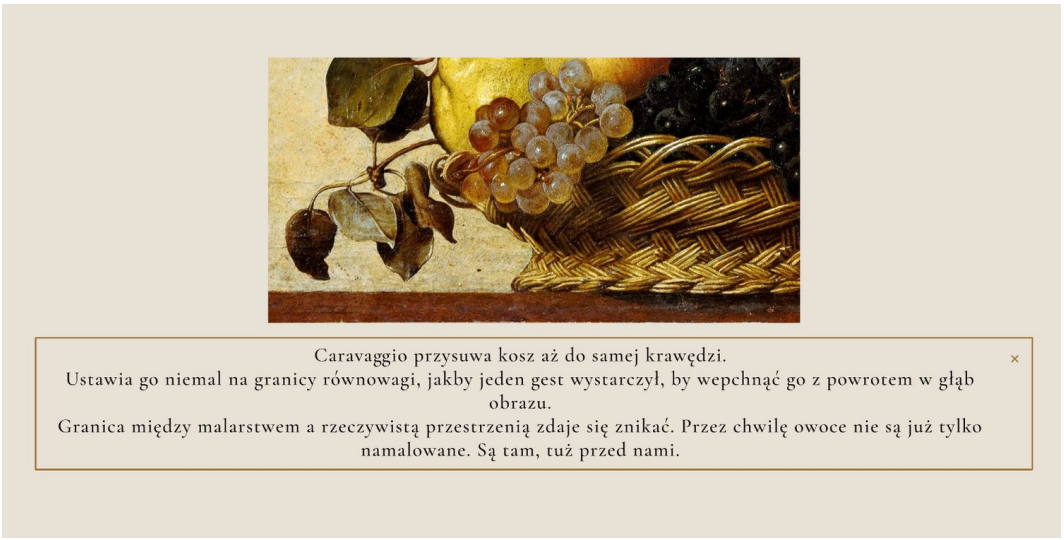
- **Focus:** the overlay covers the surrounding gallery, so no fragment of the original anecdote or of neighbouring artworks stays visible behind a shorter translation.
- **Closing:** the × (with a larger clickable area), a click outside the gold-bordered panel, or a click on the crop. Clicking inside the text keeps the helper open.
- **One opening per click:** each of the 20 live buttons has a single overlay-opening action, which prevents stacked overlays that need repeated closing clicks.
- **Hover feedback:** mouse-enter and mouse-leave events toggle a warm reflection on the button through a Boolean variable, independent of the click.

Eight languages stored in the prototype

The selector sets one shared language code. It updates the text variables bound to the anecdotes, and the helper opening actions show the matching saved panel. The choice therefore applies to both levels of storytelling. The archive holds 20 anecdotes and 20 explanations in eight languages (320 entries), stored in Figma, with no translation API call at runtime. Italian is the master text; the translations are preserved verbatim.



Language selector.



Helper for the Basket of Fruit detail in Polish. Panel size, wrapping and fonts are adjusted per language; Chinese and Japanese use fonts with CJK coverage.

Prototype and planned website

What Figma demonstrates today, and what the HTML, CSS and JavaScript implementation must add.

Area	Current prototype (Figma)	Planned website
Vertical navigation	Scroll between the opening screen and the chapter frames	Browser scrolling with chapter snap points
Chapter entry	Horizontal position follows the current prototype interaction	Settle on the chapter title when entering LIGHT, SHADOW or BLOOD
Horizontal exploration	Scroll through extended chapter frames	Horizontal containers with item-centring snap points
Discoverability	Partial artworks and captions visible at the sides	Keep side previews and add a visible horizontal scrollbar per gallery
Helpers	Focused overlays with explicit close targets	Reusable modal, one active explanation, background scroll locking, Escape support
Keyboard and focus	Shows the intended visual flow	Keyboard-operable controls; focus moved into the modal and restored to its trigger
Languages	Saved strings, text bindings and visibility flags	Local translation resources driven by one shared language state
Layout	Fixed desktop composition with per-language fitting	Responsive layouts for desktop, tablet and mobile
Media	Autoplay configured in Figma	Optimised delivery, playback controls, handling of blocked autoplay
Motion	Prototype transitions and visual states	Respect reduced-motion preferences
Hosting	Interactive Figma link	Amazon S3 and CloudFront with HTTPS

Known limitations of the current prototype

- Vertical snapping and chapter-title positioning are not coordinated: snapping to a chapter vertically does not reset its horizontal track. The website needs an explicit chapter-entry rule, using CSS scroll snapping plus JavaScript where needed.
- The prototype is a fixed desktop composition. It is not a responsive layout system, and it was not tested on every browser, device and language combination.
- The video autoplays in Figma. A short loading delay seen once disappeared after clearing the browser cache, so playback needs testing on the real website.

Next steps

Milestone	Deliverable and planned work	Deadline
Assessment 1	Interactive prototype (this submission)	27 Oct 2026
Assessment 2	Working website: HTML, CSS, JavaScript, scroll snapping, helpers, languages; hosted on S3 and CloudFront	1 Dec 2026
Assessment 3	Complete project: user testing, cross-platform checks, accessibility and performance, guestbook with API Gateway, Lambda, DynamoDB and moderation through Amazon Nova on Bedrock	5 Jan 2027

The AWS services are my own project choices and are not required by the syllabus. The full plan is in the repository (docs/work-plan-2026-2027.md).

Credits and sources

This is a non-commercial university project, created for COMP-2002 Web Development at Open Institute of Technology (OPIT) as a tribute to the art of Caravaggio.

Authorship

Concept, art direction, selection of artwork details, Italian anecdotes and helper texts, and the Figma prototype: Alessandro Benevelli. The eight-language text archive keeps the Italian master texts and the approved translations verbatim.

Paintings

Works by Michelangelo Merisi da Caravaggio. Reproductions were sourced mainly from Wikipedia pages and cropped in Figma to isolate the details. Captions in the prototype give title, date and collection or location. A per-asset source and rights register is planned before any public release of the website.

Introductory video

The video is a montage assembled by Alessandro Benevelli, who selected, trimmed and joined scenes from *Caravaggio: L'anima e il sangue* (Italian theatrical release 2018), a Sky / Sky Arte and Magnitudo Film production directed by Jesus Garces Lambert, with cinematography by Massimiliano Gatti, distributed by Nexo Digital. The project contribution is the selection and re-editing of existing scenes. The original footage is credited to the film's creators. The spoken introduction of Light, Shadow and Blood is recorded by the author.

Music

"Experience" by Ludovico Einaudi, from the album *In a Time Lapse* (2013, Decca Records). The documentary's own original score is by Matteo Curallo and is credited separately.

Design references

Apple (apple.com/it) and DATALAND, the Museum of AI Arts in Los Angeles (dataland.art). The screenshots in this document show these references and are not screens of the Caravaggio prototype. Their content belongs to their respective owners.

Links

Interactive prototype: Figma prototype
Repository (README, prototype notes, work plan, credits with source references, text archive): https://github.com/alessandrob1-star/caravaggio-light-shadow-blood

Original footage and music remain credited to their respective creators and rights holders. Source video and music files are not distributed in the repository.